

MINDFORGE • FINANCIAL SERIES

SAVINGS

Financial Planning Guide | Category 2 of 4

PPF • Emergency Fund • Financial Goals

"Bina savings ke, investment ke liye paisa bhi nahi bachega."

Safe aur guaranteed growth wale tarike is guide mein.

Savings Kya Hota Hai?

Savings ka matlab hai apna paisa **safe jagah** rakhna jahan risk bahut kam ho ya bilkul na ho, aur zaroorat padne par turant nikala ja sake. Investment mein growth zyada hoti hai lekin risk bhi hota hai — Savings isi risk ko balance karta hai. Is category mein hum dekhenge **PPF**, **Emergency Fund** aur **Financial Goals** kaise set karte hain.

■ Golden Rule

Investment shuru karne se pehle hamesha ek **Emergency Fund** bana lo — bina safety net ke investment karna risky hota hai. "Savings first, Investment after" wala rule follow karo.

1

PPF (Public Provident Fund)

Government-backed, guaranteed return wali long-term saving scheme

PPF ek **Government of India** ki saving scheme hai jisme aap har saal paisa deposit karte ho aur usme **fixed, guaranteed interest** milta hai — market ke upar-neeche jaane ka koi asar nahi padta. Yeh sabse **safe aur tax-free** investment options mein se ek maana jaata hai.

PPF ki Key Baatein

- **Lock-in Period** — 15 saal (matlab 15 saal tak poora paisa nahi nikal sakte, sirf partial withdrawal kuch conditions mein).
- **Minimum Investment** — ■500/year, Maximum ■1,50,000/year.
- **Interest Rate** — Government har quarter interest rate decide karti hai (currently ~7-8% ke around, badal sakta hai).
- **Tax Benefit** — PPF **EEE category** mein aata hai: Investment, Interest, aur Maturity teeno par tax-free hai (Section 80C ke under bhi chhoot milti hai).
- **Kaha Khulwayen** — Post Office ya kisi bhi bade Bank (SBI, HDFC, ICICI, etc.) mein account khul sakta hai.

■ Kyon Zaroori Hai?

PPF un logo ke liye best hai jo **zero-risk** ke saath long-term (retirement, bachon ki padhai) ke liye paisa jama karna chahte hain. Chunki return guaranteed hai aur tax-free bhi, yeh **safe wealth building** ka ek pillar ban sakta hai — especially un logo ke liye jo stock market ka risk nahi lena chahte.

■ Example

Agar aap PPF mein har saal ■1,00,000 deposit karte ho 15 saal tak (~7.1% rate maan ke), toh maturity par aapko approx ■27 lakh+ milega — poora tax-free.

■■ Dhyan Rakhein

PPF mein paisa **15 saal ke liye lock** ho jaata hai, isliye short-term goals (jaise 2-3 saal wali shaadi ya bike kharidni ho) ke liye PPF sahi option nahi hai. Isse sirf long-term goals ke liye use karein.

2

Emergency Fund

Buri khabar ke liye pehle se taiyari — job loss, medical emergency

Emergency Fund woh paisa hai jo aap **sirf emergencies ke liye alag rakhte ho** — jaise job chali jaaye, achanak medical bill aa jaaye, ya koi aur unexpected kharcha ho. Yeh paisa investment mein nahi lagaya jaata, balki kisi **easily accessible** jagah rakha jaata hai jahan se turant nikala ja sake.

Kitna Emergency Fund Chahiye?

- General rule: **3 se 6 mahine ke monthly expenses** jitna paisa emergency fund mein hona chahiye.
- Agar aapki income stable hai (job secure hai) — 3 mahine kaafi hai.
- Agar aap business/freelance karte ho (income uncertain hai) — 6-9 mahine rakhna better hai.

■ Emergency Fund Kaise Banayein

1. Apne monthly expenses calculate karo (rent, food, bills, EMIs sab milakar).
2. Us amount ko 3-6 se multiply karke target amount decide karo.
3. Har mahine thodi-thodi saving karke us target tak pahunchne ki koshish karo.
4. Paisa **Savings Account** ya **Liquid Mutual Fund** mein rakho — stock market mein bilkul nahi.
5. Ek baar target complete ho jaaye, us paisa ko touch mat karo — sirf real emergency mein use karo.

■ Kyon Zaroori Hai?

Emergency Fund ke bina, agar koi achanak problem aaye toh log **loan lete hain ya apni investments (jaise SIP, PPF) beech mein todhte hain** — jisse unka long-term financial plan bigad jaata hai. Emergency Fund ek **cushion** ki tarah kaam karta hai jo aapke baaki financial goals ko safe rakhta hai.

3 Financial Goals

Bina goal ke saving, bina destination ke safar jaisa hai

Financial Goals matlab aap **clearly decide** karte ho ki aap paisa kis liye bacha/invest kar rahe ho, kitna chahiye, aur kab tak chahiye. Bina goal ke saving karna mushkil hota hai kyunki koi clear direction nahi hoti — Financial Goals aapko ek **roadmap** dete hain.

Financial Goals ke Types (Time ke hisaab se)

- **Short-term Goals** (0-3 saal) — jaise naya phone, bike, chhoti trip. Isme Savings Account ya FD use karein.
- **Medium-term Goals** (3-7 saal) — jaise shaadi, car, house down payment. Isme Mutual Funds/SIP better hain.
- **Long-term Goals** (7+ saal) — jaise retirement, bachon ki padhai, ghar kharidna. Isme PPF, Equity Mutual Funds, Stock Market use karein.

■ Apna Financial Goal Kaise Set Karein (SMART Method)

1. **Specific** — Clearly likho kya chahiye (jaise "Bike kharidni hai").
2. **Measurable** — Amount decide karo (jaise "₹1,00,000").
3. **Achievable** — Apni income ke hisaab se realistic amount rakho.
4. **Relevant** — Goal aapki zindagi ke liye zaroori hona chahiye.
5. **Time-bound** — Deadline set karo (jaise "18 mahine mein").

■ Kyon Zaroori Hai?

Jab goals clear hote hain, toh aap sahi investment option choose kar paate ho — short goal ke liye risky stock market use nahi karoge, aur long goal ke liye sirf saving account mein paisa nahi rakhoge. Yeh **right money, right place, right time** ka formula hai.

■ Example

Goal: "5 saal mein ₹5,00,000 ka down payment jama karna hai." Isko todhne par: monthly ~₹6,500-7,000 SIP se (12% return maan ke) yeh target achieve ho sakta hai — bina goal set kiye yeh calculation possible hi nahi thi.

Quick Comparison

Option	Risk Level	Best For
PPF	Zero (Govt-backed)	Long-term, tax-free safe growth
Emergency Fund	Zero	Sudden expenses, job loss, medical needs
Financial Goals	N/A (planning tool)	Directing savings/investments smartly

➡■ Next Category

Agli PDF mein hum **Category 3: Insurance** cover karenge — LIC, Term Insurance aur Health Insurance ke baare mein.